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I am going to skip a whole lot that I am sure would interest us but you will be easily able to guess all about what would naturally follow if I had time to continue. So I would like just now to stress one feature of mutual harmony between man and wife that it seems to me must next to everything in matrimonial and family-life. What is it? ? ? I almost forgot to tell you first that a recent letter concerning your family - rather just a few lines of a report about you - took a tear from my eye: D. and C. and the whole family situation immeasurably improved." Pardon brevity. Now what I wanted to stress is this: The supreme importance for PEACE sake in a family that the husband or the mother, adjust their likes - their ideals - so as to harmonize with those of the other "life-partner", thus renewing and reenforcing their "courting-days affection" for one another, edifying the children and neighbors and, in this "vale of tears" helping to convince all concerned that after all the very possibility of our making the grade and gaining the eternal goal is worth infinitely more than the comparatively trifling sacrifices demanded.

Just a little example that I now remember ought to make what I want to say, interestingly clear and pertinent. About the time I was ordained (1904), the whole current press - Catholic as well as general - seemed to focus almost dangerously undue attention on a certain Tolstoi as the outstanding general genius of the hour and of the age. Said to be "handsome and extremely wealthy" without setting too much importance on either, Count Leo Tolstoi

(Unfinished carbon copy)